



Inspection Report

Edwin M Stoutz
P.O. Box 850996
New Orleans, LA 70185

Customer ID: **24398**
Certificate: **72-B-0126**
Site: 004
Edwin M Stoutz

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION
Date: 17-AUG-2026

2.1(b)(2)(ii)

Requirements and application

The licensee is brokering exotic/wild canids without having the appropriate authorization. On May 23, 2024, the licensee acquired a female Fennec Fox from 5H Ranch Animal Auction. The licensee sold the animal on May 25, 2024. Furthermore, the licensee has a Fennec Fox and a Bat-Eared Fox on breeding loan at another facility. The licensee's current 3-year license does not have authorization for wild and exotic canids. Not acquiring the correct license designations prior to obtaining restricted animal species can result in animals being held by unauthorized or untrained personnel for the species. Per the regulations, licenses authorize the use of animals subject to subparts A through F in part 3 of this subchapter, except that, for animals subject to subparts D and F, licenses must specifically authorize the use of each of the following groups of animals: Group 5 (baboons and non-brachiating species larger than 33 lbs.) and Group 6 (great apes over 55 lbs. and brachiating species) nonhuman primates; exotic and wild felids (including but not limited to lions, tigers, leopards, cheetahs, jaguars, cougars, lynx, servals, bobcats, and caracals, and any hybrid cross thereof); hyenas and/or exotic and wild canids (including but not limited to wolves, coyotes, foxes, and jackals); bears; and mega-herbivores (including but not limited to elephants, rhinoceroses, hippopotamuses, and giraffes). A licensee must obtain a new license before using any animal beyond those types or numbers of animals authorized under the existing license. Correct by August 25, 2026.

2.40(a)(1) Direct

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

At the time of the inspection there wasn't documentation of the Attending Veterinarian's (AV's) annual visits to the facility as outlined in the written Program of Veterinary Care. The AV was contacted by phone on 8/18/2026 and confirmed they have never conducted site visits for any of the licensee's sites. Due to the lack of regularly scheduled visits the Attending Veterinarian has not had an opportunity to evaluate or respond to the welfare concerns and unsanitary conditions. Regular visits to the facility are important because the AV evaluates the animals and their care and can give important professional advice regarding the health and welfare of the animals including all aspects of their husbandry. Each dealer and exhibitor shall employ an attending veterinarian under formal arrangements. In the case of a part-time attending veterinarian or consultant arrangements, the formal arrangements shall include a written program of veterinary care and regularly scheduled visits to the premises of the dealer or exhibitor. Correct by September 18, 2026.

3.1(c)(3)

Prepared By: SARAH ROLOFF
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title: COMPLIANCE SPECIALIST

Date:
18-AUG-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative

Date:
18-AUG-2026



Inspection Report

Housing facilities, general.

The surfaces of the indoor housing facility containing four adult cats are not being cleaned and sanitized in an appropriate manner. The enclosure was splattered with excreta and organic material along the floors and extended approximately 3 feet up on the walls. The facility representative stated they do try and spot clean daily. USDA personnel saw fecal material in a wire crate in the corner of the room and asked about a litter box. An animal caretaker stated something to the effect of they don't need a litter box, "they shit on the floor". The accumulation of dirt and organic debris shows the lack of proper cleaning and sanitization. Improper cleaning and sanitization can increase the risk of contamination and spread of disease hazards to the cats.

The licensee must ensure that hard surfaces with which the cats come in contact are spot-cleaned daily and sanitized in accordance with 3.11(b) to prevent the accumulation of excreta and reduce disease hazards.
Correct by August 25, 2026.

3.1(e)

Housing facilities, general.

The facility did not store the open bag of cat food with a tightly fitted lid. At the time of inspection, USDA personnel observed an Asian Small-Clawed Otter diving into the container to eat the food. Improper storage of food and bedding supplies may lead to spoilage and contamination. All supplies of food and bedding must be stored off the floor and away from walls, to allow cleaning underneath and around the supplies. Open supplies of food and bedding must be kept in leakproof containers with tightly fitting lids to prevent contamination and spoilage.

Correct by August 25, 2026.

3.28(a)(3)

Primary enclosures.

The facility did not provide clean bedding material to a single-housed hamster. The bedding material was discolored brown and dark green in the front left section of the enclosure. There was large accumulation of feces in the same corner. The lack of clean bedding can lead to contamination of the animals, strong odors and spread of disease. Correct by providing clean bedding material to the hamster.

Correct by August 21, 2026.

3.55

Direct

Watering.

The facility failed to supply adequate potable water for a domestic shorthair rabbit. USDA personnel entered the room and discovered a nearly empty water bottle receptacle affixed to the outside of the rabbit's enclosure. The receptacle was positioned at an angle, preventing the rabbit from accessing the small amount of water available. USDA personnel requested that the licensee provide water for the rabbit. The rabbit then drank vigorously for about 45 seconds. During this period, USDA personnel helped by tilting the bottle to ensure the water receptacle was replenishing. Failure to provide sufficient quantities of potable water may result in dehydration, illness or death to the animals. The facility must provide sufficient potable water daily.

Correct by August 18, 2026.

3.56(a)(2)

Direct

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Inspection Report

Sanitation.

The facility failed to remove soiled litter at least once a week in an enclosure housing one domestic short-haired rabbit. An excessive accumulation of feces was mixed throughout the litter. The litter was also discolored and stained yellow in some areas indicating continued heavy urine accumulation. The rabbit could not avoid stepping on or laying on feces within the enclosure. Excessive accumulations of feces can allow for the spread of disease hazards, create unpleasant odors and attract pests. In primary enclosures equipped with solid floors, soiled litter shall be removed and replaced with clean litter at least once each week.

Correct by August 19, 2026.

3.125(a)

Facilities, general.

The facility was not maintaining indoor and outdoor housing facilities in good repair to protect the animals from injury and to contain the animals.

At the time of the inspection, USDA personnel saw an uncontained chinchilla freely moving on top of a collapsed enclosure stacked approximately six feet high. The facility representative explained that the chinchilla had escaped its primary enclosure with its cage mates and did not know how it had escaped. Several plastic hideouts within the chinchilla enclosure had holes from chewed surfaces. Additionally, there was a cardboard hideout/perch that had evidence of significant chewing damage.

The enclosure for two Spotted Genets wasn't maintained in good repair. There was a separation between the solid metal at the base of the enclosure wall and the wire mesh at the top of the wall creating holes that vary in size from 1"x3" to 3"x3". In addition, the wire mesh wall was showing signs of rust and decay. Additionally, a screw point was protruding into the enclosure.

The enclosure for two coatimundis had a black plastic perch suspended from the ceiling by ropes. One of the ropes was broken and frayed, leaving the perch hanging precariously to one side.

Failure to maintain housing facilities so that they are structurally sound and in good repair can increase the possibility of injury to the animals.

Correct by maintaining indoor and outdoor housing facilities in good repair to protect the animals from injury and to contain the animals.

Correct by August 26, 2026.

3.126(b)

Facilities, indoor.

The facility is not adequately ventilating the indoor housing area for the health and comfort of the animals. USDA personnel encountered a strong odor of ammonia from outside of the facility. The odor was present throughout the front room and the kangaroo's animal housing area. The facility had laundry piled in front of the front room's door preventing natural ventilation. The air-conditioning was actively running during the time of the inspection but didn't provide adequate ventilation to address the excessive ammonia odor. The facility representative stated that time between cleaning in the building has ranged from one to two weeks. High levels of ammonia can cause discomfort to the animals and lead to further health issues.

The facility must ensure indoor housing facilities shall be adequately ventilated by natural or mechanical means to provide for the health and to prevent discomfort of the animals at all times. Such facilities shall be provided with fresh air either by means of windows, doors, vents, fans, or air-conditioning and shall be ventilated so as to minimize drafts, odors, and

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moisture condensation.
Correct by August 28, 2026.

3.129(a)

Feeding.

The facility failed to provide food that is wholesome, palatable, and free from contamination to the Spotted Genets and coatimundis.

The Genets' food receptacle was placed on the floor of the enclosure without protection from the elements or insect pests. The food receptacle was filled to the brim with pelleted feed that appeared to have solidified into one large mass due to the previous day's rainstorm. USDA inspectors observed multiple flies present on and within the food. The feed for two Coatimundis was on the floor of their enclosure. The feed was mixed into the dirt substrate that contained excessive feces and fuzzy white organic material.

Failure to provide wholesome and palatable food to animals can result in malnutrition, exposure to contaminants (mold), and disease. Correct by ensuring that the food is wholesome, palatable, and free from contamination and of sufficient quantity and nutritive value to maintain all animals in good health. The diet shall be prepared with consideration for the age, species, condition, size, and type of animal. Animals shall be fed at least once a day except as dictated by hibernation, veterinary treatment, normal fasts, or other professionally accepted practices.

Correct by August 20, 2026.

3.130

Direct

Watering.

The facility didn't provide water as often as necessary for the health and comfort of the animals. A pair of Three-Banded Armadillos, two Sugar Gliders, and one Asian Small Clawed Otter didn't have access to water at the time of the inspection. USDA personnel asked the licensee to provide them with water.

The armadillos had a poultry gravity waterer that was completely empty and turned over. Once offered water, they proceeded to drink water eagerly and continuously for approximately 7 minutes. The Asian Small Clawed Otter was enclosed in a bathroom without access to water when USDA personnel arrived at the facility. The licensee released the animal to the kitchen and living room area. The Otter immediately ran to the water bowl and drank for approximately 30 seconds while sporadically running to greet the other animals. The Sugar Gliders' water receptacle was completely dry. The licensee refilled the water receptacle, but the animals are nocturnal and were asleep at the time of the inspection. Failure to provide sufficient quantities of potable water can result in dehydration, illness or death to the animals. The facility must provide sufficient water as necessary for the health and comfort of the animals.

Correct by August 18, 2026.

3.131(a)

Direct

Sanitation.

The facility failed to remove excreta from the primary enclosures of several species to prevent contamination of the animals contained therein and to minimize disease hazards and to reduce odors.

The outdoor primary enclosure for two Spotted Genets had excessive excreta and organic material mixed in with discarded food and dirt throughout the enclosure. USDA personnel USDA inspectors found feces exhibiting various levels of decomposition, indicating that it has been building up for more than just a few days. The Genets could not avoid stepping in the organic material and excreta.

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The outdoor primary enclosure for two coatimundis had excessive excreta and organic material accumulation throughout the enclosure. A mixture of discarded food, fur, trash, white organic material and varying ages of feces was scattered throughout the dirt floor of the enclosure and inside the shelter. The animals could not avoid stepping in the organic material and excreta in order to get to their food receptacle.

The indoor primary enclosure for one Red Kangaroo and one ferret had excreta and organic material smeared on the flooring, furniture, and walls. The fur on the kangaroo's hindlimbs was wet from unknown fluids [not from the water bowl] on the kitchen floor. This area had a strong smell of ammonia and feces that irritated inspectors' upper airways.

The indoor primary enclosure for one Asian Small Clawed Otter was covered in organic material and excreta. The animal was housed in an indoor bathroom where it had unrestricted access to the whole space. Once the otter was let into the main living area, USDA staff entered the bathroom and observed a chaotic scene of towels, litter, animal waste, and toilet cleaning products. Excreta was spread across the floor, and a potent odor of feces and ammonia permeated the bathroom.

The indoor primary enclosures for two sugar gliders, three chinchillas, a wooly possum, a singly housing three-banded enclosure and a pair of three-banded armadillos had an excessive accumulation of feces, fur and/or discarded food present. The sugar gliders had excessive accumulation of old, white colored feces on top of one of their sleeping pouches and within the bedding below their pouches. The chinchillas had a thick layer of feces mixed with fur and dirt on the upper resting platform of the enclosure. The bottom of the enclosure was constructed of wire and couldn't be visualized due to the presence of feed bags, storage materials and other paraphernalia blocking the USDA's inspector's path. The wooly possum's enclosure was placed directly over the chinchillas' cage. It had a wire bottom with a black plastic catch board that was completely filled with pelleted feces. The single housed armadillo had an accumulation of hair and cobwebs covering the metal wire portion of the enclosure. The enclosure housing a pair of armadillos had excessive accumulation of cobwebs over the metal bars and excessive accumulation of feces scattered throughout the bedding. The room containing these animals had a strong smell of feces and ammonia that irritated inspectors' upper airways.

Accumulations of feces, urine, and soiled bedding are harmful to the animals as they can spread disease, attract pests, and cause unpleasant odors. Excreta shall be removed from primary enclosures as often as necessary to prevent contamination of the animals contained therein and to minimize disease hazards and to reduce odors.

Correct by August 20, 2026.

3.131(c)

Sanitation.

The facility failed to keep the premises clean.

The outdoor backyard area had an assortment of unused crates, trash, and other discarded materials scattered throughout the overgrown grass. USDA inspectors had to carefully maneuver around and move some of these obstacles to evaluate the enclosures for the Spotted Genets and Coatimundis. Multiple empty travel crates were stacked in the indoor animal housing area, "the front room", obstructing access to the enclosures. The accumulation of travel containers, feed, bedding materials, empty enclosures interfered with USDA personnel's ability to adequately observe all the animals in the room.

Failure to adequately clean the premises can lead to illness, transmission of diseases, and attract unwanted pests. The facility must ensure that the premises are kept clean and in good repair to protect the animals from injury to facilitate the prescribed husbandry practices set forth in this subpart.

Correct by September 1, 2026.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representative.

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Additional Inspectors:

E RODRIGUEZ, VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
24398	72-B-0126	004	Edwin M Stoutz	17-AUG-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000004	<i>Felis catus</i>	CAT ADULT
000003	<i>Chinchilla lanigera</i>	CHINCHILLA
000001	<i>Mesocricetus auratus</i>	SYRIAN / GOLDEN HAMSTER
000002	<i>Petaurus breviceps</i>	SUGAR GLIDER
000003	<i>Tolypeutes matacus</i>	SOUTHERN THREE-BANDED ARMADILLO
000001	<i>Oryctolagus cuniculus</i>	DOMESTIC RABBIT / EUROPEAN RABBIT
000001	<i>Paradoxurus hermaphroditus</i>	COMMON PALM CIVET
000002	<i>Nasua olivacea</i>	MOUNTAIN COATI
000002	<i>Genetta genetta</i>	SMALL SPOTTED GENET
000001	<i>Mustela putorius furo</i>	DOMESTIC FERRET
000001	<i>Osphranter rufus</i>	RED KANGAROO
000001	<i>Aonyx cinereus</i>	ORIENTAL SMALL-CLAWED OTTER
000001	<i>Caluromys derbianus</i>	CENTRAL AMERICAN WOOLLY OPOSSUM
000023	Total	